

SANGJUN (SAMUEL) Ko

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Staffmark Group (on assignment at Kimberly-Clark)

Neenah, Wisconsin

Statistician

June 2025 - Present

- Design and run DOE-based lab experiments and curate bench and consumer-study data for regression models that predict consumer perception from physical measurements—supporting lower-cost product screening across five product lines
- Build and deploy six internal Python/Flask analytics modules (50+ users) that turn manual statistical workflows—predictive models and lab-report automation—into self-service tools, serving as a primary technical contact for the platform
- Run 80+ mannequin leakage analyses per year using ANOVA, mixed models, and pairwise comparisons, and support DOE-based development of a mannequin screening method that reduces reliance on lengthy consumer studies
- Design and analyze 15+ Gauge R&R / test-method validation studies—including attribute (Kappa) validations, equipment equivalency, and method transfers—developing study designs, sample-size plans, and acceptance-criteria recommendations across multiple product categories

STAT107 Data Science Discovery

Champaign, Illinois

Undergraduate Course Assistant

August 2023 - May 2025

- Assisted over 300 students with fundamental data science concepts through interactive labs
- Managed Git for learning platform modifications, benefiting 1000+ students; created, edited, and proofread course materials

Applied Technologies for Learning in Arts & Sciences

Champaign, Illinois

AI/ML Intern Team Leader

January 2024 - December 2024

- Led a team of 5 interns and collaborated closely with 3 managers in weekly meetings
- Built ML models with 100,000+ data points using Python and advanced techniques like XGBoost and BERT

PROJECTS / AWARDS

Graduation Prediction Model

September 2024 - December 2024

- Increased AUC score from 0.65 to 0.82 by reducing noise in the dataset through feature engineering and outlier removal across 50,000+ student records
- Built a Streamlit interface with 12 key predictors for real-time predictions for university administrators

3rd Place, 2024 CIC Student Paper Challenge (Columbia University)

September 2024

- Analyzed socioeconomic and mental health impacts of COVID-19 in Mexico using geospatial and statistical analysis, identifying that 42% of females and 40% of young adults faced job loss

SKILLS

Languages:	English (Fluent), Spanish (Native), Korean (Native)
Statistics:	Design of Experiments (DOE), Mixed Models/ANOVA, Multiple Comparisons, Gauge R&R / MSA, Method Validation (TMV), Regression & Predictive Modeling
Programming:	Python (Advanced): Pandas, NumPy, SciPy, statsmodels, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, Matplotlib; R (Intermediate): Tidyverse, ggplot2, caret; SQL, SAS, Excel/VBA
Tools & Web:	Flask, Docker, Git, JMP, HTML/CSS, JavaScript (Chart.js, Plotly), Tableau, Office
Certificates:	Data Science Certificate, Coursera Business Analytics Certificate

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Champaign, Illinois

Bachelor of Science in Statistics (CGPA: 3.93/4.00)

January 2023 - May 2025

- Mathematics Minor

COMMUNITY SERVICE AND EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Volunteer, Appleton Public Library

August 2025 - Present

- Help run a twice-weekly teen gaming night (2 hrs/session, 5–10 participants): organize the event, take attendance, and set up gaming consoles, puzzles, and other activities

Consultant in Illinois Business Consulting

September 2024 - December 2024

- Collaborated with interdisciplinary teams to deliver strategic solutions for real-world business challenges, including market analysis, operational optimization, and growth strategy, for clients ranging from Fortune 100 companies to nonprofits